

Patterns of Cannabis Use Among Sexual Minority Adults

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Background



Cannabis is the most commonly used federally illegal drug in the US.¹



Approved medical uses include depression, anxiety, PTSD, and substance use disorders.²



LGBTQ+ individuals are disproportionately impacted by these same conditions.³

Recent research shows sexual minority adults are more likely to use cannabis but patterns of how they consume it remain underexplored.⁴

This study uses 2022–2023 BRFSS data to examine prevalence and modality of cannabis use across sexual orientation–sex groups.

Conclusion

Sexual minorities, especially bisexual adults, report higher prevalence and more non-traditional use (e.g., edibles, vaping, dabbing).

Different modalities carry distinct risk profiles, requiring tailored public health responses.

These patterns reflect broader mental health disparities in LGBTQ+ communities.

Highlight the need for inclusive, identity-informed harm reduction and surveillance.

Public health must engage with cannabis policy to prevent repeating the harms seen with tobacco and alcohol.

Figure 1. Weighted Prevalence of Past-Month Cannabis Use by Sexual Orientation-Sex Group (BRFSS 2022–2023)

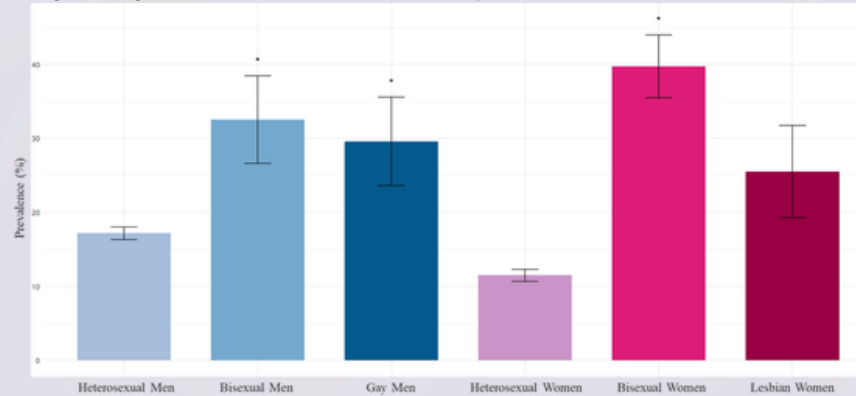
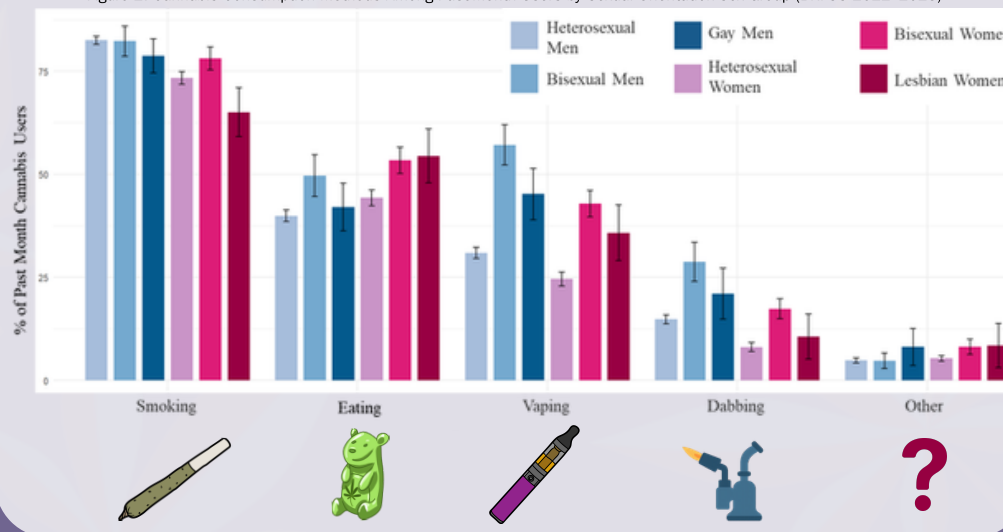


Figure 2. Cannabis Consumption Methods Among Past-Month Users by Sexual Orientation-Sex Group (BRFSS 2022–2023)



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Results

Prevalence:

39.7% – Bisexual women
 32.5% – Bisexual men
 29.6% – Gay men
 25.5% – Lesbian women
 17.2% – Heterosexual men
 11.5% – Heterosexual women

Modality:

Smoking

Highest: Hetero men (82.3%)
 Lowest: Lesbian Women (65.1%)

Edibles

Highest: Lesbian women (54.4%)
 Lowest: Gay men (33.1%)

Vaping

Highest: Bisexual men (57.1%)
 Lowest: Hetero women (24.6%)

Dabbing

Highest: Bisexual men (28.7%)
 Lowest: Hetero women (8.1%)

Other

Highest: Gay men (8.4%)
 Lowest: Hetero women (4.8%)

